

A Muslim NATO Is Taking Shape-And Israel Is Already In The Crosshairs

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Something potentially historic is taking shape in the Muslim world.

Turkey, Saudi Arabia and Pakistan have signed a new mutual-defense agreement that does far more than promise closer military cooperation. Under the pact, an armed attack against one member will be considered an attack against all three--a collective-defense principle Turkey's foreign minister has openly compared to NATO's Article 5.

That alone would deserve attention.

But what happened next should get Israel's attention.

Within days of the agreement, Pakistan's defense minister Khawaja Asif called Israel an "illegitimate" state and urged Muslim nations to form a "united military front" against the Jewish state.

Suddenly, what might have been dismissed as another regional security agreement raises a much larger question:

Are we witnessing the early formation of a Muslim NATO--and if it expands, could Israel eventually become one of the threats around which it unites?

Three Nations, Three Different Kinds Of Power

The new alliance brings together an extraordinary combination of capabilities.

Turkey possesses one of the largest militaries in the region and NATO's second-largest army. It also has a rapidly expanding defense industry producing drones, missiles, armored vehicles and other advanced weapons.

Saudi Arabia brings enormous financial resources, growing military capabilities and something even more important politically: its position as guardian of Islam's two holiest cities, Mecca and Medina.

Then there is Pakistan.

Pakistan is not simply another Muslim military power.

It is a nuclear weapons state.

That changes the strategic calculation dramatically.

The agreement does not publicly state that Pakistan's nuclear arsenal would automatically defend Saudi Arabia or Turkey. Officials have emphasized that the pact is defensive and is not aimed at any particular country.

Nevertheless, any alliance containing a nuclear-armed member possesses a deterrent dimension that cannot simply be ignored.

For decades Israel has maintained overwhelming strategic superiority over most of its regional adversaries.

But what happens if an expanding Islamic security structure eventually operates beneath the shadow of Pakistan's nuclear weapons?

That question alone makes this pact far more significant than another diplomatic ceremony.

And It May Not Stop At Three

Perhaps the most important detail is that the alliance may expand.

Turkish officials have already raised Egypt as a possible future participant, while a permanent ministerial committee and secretariat are being established to oversee the alliance.

Think about what that could eventually mean.

Turkey. Saudi Arabia. Pakistan. Egypt.

Four of the most consequential Sunni Muslim countries would collectively possess enormous manpower, advanced weapons industries, major financial resources, strategic control over critical waterways--and nuclear weapons through Pakistan.

No one should assume such an alliance would automatically become anti-Israel.

Saudi Arabia still has powerful reasons to maintain relations with Washington and has explored normalization with Israel. Turkey remains a NATO member. Egypt has maintained peace with Israel for decades.

But alliances change.

Governments change.

And threats change.

Institutions built today for one crisis can be redirected toward another tomorrow.

That is why Pakistan's rhetoric matters.

When the defense minister of the alliance's only nuclear-armed member is already publicly calling for Muslim military unity against Israel, Israelis have every reason to listen carefully.

The First Test May Already Be Here

Remarkably, the alliance may not have to wait long before facing its first practical question.

Only days after the agreement was signed, Iran-aligned Houthi forces claimed an attack on Saudi Arabia's Jazan oil refinery.

The timing immediately raised questions about the meaning of the new mutual-defense commitment.

Does an attack by a proxy organization qualify as aggression against Saudi Arabia?

Would Pakistan or Turkey provide military assistance?

Would the pact apply only during a direct interstate war?

Those details remain unresolved.

But if Turkey and Pakistan eventually begin participating operationally in Saudi Arabia's defense, the agreement will have moved from diplomatic language into functioning collective security.

And once that machinery exists, it can potentially be used against other threats as well.

Israel Should Watch The Architecture, Not Just Today's Intentions

The most important lesson may be this: geopolitical structures frequently outlive the circumstances that created them.

The alliances that existed before World War I were not originally created because everyone expected a continental war. They were mechanisms of mutual security that became enormously consequential once events changed.

The same principle applies here.

Today, Iran and its proxies may be one of the greatest forces driving Sunni Muslim states toward deeper military cooperation.

Tomorrow the focus could be somewhere else.

And one senior Pakistani official has already made clear where he believes Muslim military power should eventually be directed.

Israel.

Turkey has long suggested the Muslim world need to unify around it's opposition to Israel.

Saudi Arabia has appeared to be more moderate to Israel in recent years but at the heart of it's Kingdom is still Islamic principles and true Islamists will never make peace with Israel.

When Israel Becomes The Issue That Unites Its Enemies

There is another dimension to this development that students of Bible prophecy should not overlook.

The Bible does describe something broader--and arguably more striking.

Israel and Jerusalem increasingly becoming an international point of confrontation.

Zechariah 12 describes Jerusalem becoming a "cup of trembling" and a "burdensome stone" to the nations.

The remarkable thing about Israel's position today is how frequently the Jewish state becomes the issue around which countries with profoundly different interests suddenly discover common ground.

Turkey and Saudi Arabia have spent years competing for influence across the Muslim world.

Pakistan sits thousands of miles from Jerusalem and faces enormous security challenges of its own.

Yet almost immediately after these three nations established a new collective-defense structure, Pakistan's defense minister was publicly calling upon Muslim countries to unite militarily against Israel.

That should get our attention.

This illustrates something the prophets foresaw long ago: Jerusalem possesses an extraordinary ability to draw the attention of nations far beyond its borders.

Why should a country the size of Israel occupy such an enormous place in global politics?

Why should Jerusalem--a relatively small city in geographic terms--continually provoke resolutions, summits, demonstrations, diplomatic confrontations and threats of war across continents?

From a purely geopolitical perspective, it is remarkable.

From a biblical perspective, perhaps it should not surprise us at all.

The significant development is that the military infrastructure through which Muslim nations can coordinate is growing at the same time Israel is increasingly being presented as a common enemy capable of uniting them.

Today their interests overlap in some areas and clash in others.

Tomorrow circumstances may change.

But Scripture warned thousands of years ago that the world's attention would eventually return again and again to Israel--and especially Jerusalem.

The treaty signed today may therefore matter less for what it currently is than for what it could eventually become.

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